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1. Executive Summary

This plan replaces the rent-to-mine model with an owned-hardware model. Instead of paying Vast or RunPod $0.86-2.49 per GPU-hour to access cards that then have to out-earn that rent, we buy two Blackwell GPUs outright, list them on three rental marketplaces for a stable USDT floor, and run Bittensor subnets on the same cards whenever the projected mining yield beats the rental rate. Every number in this document is grounded in live October 2026 data: measured Salad payout rates, Vast median asks, the Lium fleet feed, and the per-subnet emission tables from the Infranex BT platform itself.

The economics come down to three findings. First, hosting is the floor: a measured Salad-class income of $0.281 per card-hour (idle hours included) plus Vast/Lium spike capture supports $210-450 per card-month at realistic utilization. Second, mining is the option, not the plan: the best-paying GPU subnets reward only 1-3 of 256 registered miners, and on SN51 - the subnet we studied deepest - the top 10% of UIDs captured 99.1% of epoch emissions. A new entrant should model mining at $30-500 per card-month, never as the payback driver. Third, the hardware itself is a volatile asset: the RTX 5090 doubled from $2,000 to $5,000+ street in eight months, which inflates entry cost today but also gives the rig an unusually strong resale floor if the thesis fails.

Three rig configurations are modeled. Rig A (2x RTX 5090, about $12,990) pays back in 7.5-41 months across conservative-to-optimistic scenarios, with a base case near 18 months. Rig B (4x 5090, about $27,900) is the scale play once Phase 1 proves the model. Rig C (2x RTX PRO 6000 Blackwell WS, about $39,100) is the only track that unlocks TEE-gated subnets such as SN4 Targon, but its $16,000-per-card entry price makes it a Phase 3 decision at best. The recommended path is phased: Rig A now, expansion gated on tracked performance, and the dynamic auto-switch strategy implemented in Infranex BT so the rig never sits in its lowest-earning mode.

7%
Lium fleet utilization 48 h after peaking at 85% - platform risk is real

$0.281/hr
Measured RTX 5090 income on Salad, idle hours included

18 mo
Rig A base-case payback (range 7.5-41 months)

2. Market Context: Why Owned Beats Rented

The starting hypothesis is confirmed by the numbers in this project's own dataset. Renting a 5090-class card on Vast at the $0.86 median rate costs roughly $620 per month before a single token of mining revenue, while the same card draws about $85-105 of electricity. For the rental to clear its own cost, the card must out-earn $0.86/hour around the clock on subnets whose median rewarded miner earns little or nothing. Ownership deletes the $620 rent line entirely and converts it into an asset with residual value.

The Oct 2026 hardware market inflates entry but hedges exit. GDDR7 supply has been absorbed by AI datacenter demand - IDC estimates AI could consume up to 70% of global memory output in 2026 - and

Tom's Hardware tracked the 5090 crossing $5,000 in September, with October marketplace listings at $5,000-7,000+ against a $1,999 MSRP. The RTX PRO 6000 Blackwell WS went from $8,565 at launch to $16,000 at the NVIDIA Marketplace. Buying now means paying a bubble premium; it also means the collateral backing the rig has demonstrated appreciation, and the plan's kill-switch (reselling cards into a shortage) is unusually valuable. The procurement chapter therefore models street price both 30% down and 30% up.

On the revenue side, the three rental platforms behave very differently. Vast.ai is the deepest marketplace with interruptible pricing; SaladCloud's measured 5090 income of $0.281/hour already nets out idle time (97% job-time) and is the most reliable floor; Lium pays the best share (95% in USDT) and sits adjacent to Bittensor demand, but its fleet utilization collapsed from 85% (1,543 of 1,816 GPUs rented) on October 24 to 7% (27 of 405) on October 25 - a 48-hour demonstration that no single platform can be trusted with 100% of capacity. The table below is the live snapshot that motivated the multi-platform design.

GPU model	Rented / listed	Utilization	Median ask $/hr
H100 80GB HBM3	3 / 169	2%	2.00
H200	13 / 67	19%	4.21
RTX PRO 6000 Blackwell SE	0 / 48	0%	2.09
B300 SXM6 AC	2 / 32	6%	8.50
RTX 5090	1 / 27	4%	0.90
RTX A6000	6 / 16	38%	0.42
RTX 4090	0 / 6	0%	0.80

Table 2.1 - Lium public fleet snapshot, Oct 25, 2026 (96 nodes, 405 GPUs). Two days earlier the same feed showed 1,816 GPUs at 85% rented.

3. Hardware Tracks: Three Rig Options

All three configurations use Blackwell-class GPUs, but they differ in scale and in a capability gate that matters more than raw TFLOPS: TEE support. Several of the highest-yielding subnets - SN4 Targon, SN90 KubeTEE, SN64 Chutes, and the TEE-class hosting gates documented in the app's Miner Playbook - require Intel TDX or NVIDIA confidential-compute hardware profiles. Consumer RTX 5090 cards do not support CC mode; the RTX PRO 6000 Blackwell workstation card does. That single spec divides the plan into a budget track (Rigs A and B, maximum TFLOPS per dollar) and a compliance track (Rig C, minimum competition per reward pool).

Rig A is the proving rig: two 5090s on a mainstream AM5 platform, 1.47 kW at the wall under load, and enough VRAM (64 GB aggregate) for every consumer-track subnet shortlist. Rig B doubles the cards and moves to a Threadripper/WRX90 platform because four 5090s need x16 electrical slots, 2 kW of stable delivery, and ECC memory for 24/7 duty. Rig C swaps consumer cards for two PRO 6000s - 96 GB each,

CC mode, and access to Salad's new Dedicated reserved tier - at the cost of three times the GPU capex. Power figures below are wall draws at 90% PSU efficiency including the host system.

Spec	Rig A - Budget Blackwell	Rig B - Scale Play	Rig C - TEE Track
GPUs	2x RTX 5090 (32 GB)	4x RTX 5090 (32 GB)	2x RTX PRO 6000 WS (96 GB)
Aggregate VRAM	64 GB	128 GB	192 GB
TEE / CC mode	No	No	Yes (unlocks SN4, SN90, SN64 class)
GPU capex	$10,400	$20,800	$32,000
Platform capex	$2,590	$7,100	$7,100
Total capex	$12,990	$27,900	$39,100
Wall power (load)	1.47 kW	2.86 kW	1.64 kW
Power $/mo @ $0.12	$127	$247	$142
Subnet reach	SN74, SN94, SN9-class	SN74, SN94, SN9-class	TEE subnets + all consumer-class

Table 3.1 - Rig configurations. Capex at Oct 2026 street prices: 5090 $5,200/card midpoint, PRO 6000 $16,000/card NVIDIA Marketplace.

4. Revenue Model: Two Streams

Stream 1 - the rental floor. Each card is listed simultaneously on Lium (Secure tier to avoid the 48-hour rental-price debt mechanism), Vast (interruptible) and Salad (always-on). The blended host share across the three platforms is about 93% of the ask. At the live 5090 ask of $0.90/hour, one card generates $211/month at 35% utilization, $301 at 50%, and $452 at 75%. The PRO 6000's $2.09 ask scales the same arithmetic to $280-770, though its demand pool is thinner (48 listed, 0 rented on the Lium feed used here), so its utilization scenarios are deliberately set lower.

Stream 2 - the mining option. The app's Miner Playbook ranks every subnet by realizable paper value per earning miner; the shortlist below filters for what each rig can actually run. The headline numbers are seductive and misleading: SN9's $8,883/day per earner is real for the two miners currently rewarded, but 256 are registered, so the pool-implied expectation is $69/day - and a new entrant without optimized inference stacks should haircut that heavily. The honest planning numbers are $30 (conservative) to $500 (optimistic) per consumer card-month, which the sensitivity chapter stress-tests. Gittensor (SN74) is the most accessible entry for a 5090 because it rewards verified code contributions rather than raw inference throughput.

Subnet	Hardware gate	Per-earner paper value	Rewarded / registered	Implied pool EV*	Fit
SN74 Gittensor	RTX 5090 (32 GB)	$2,622 /d	1 / 256	$10.2 /d	Rig A, B
SN94 Cathedral	1x CUDA GPU >= 24 GB	$2,732 /d	1 / 256	$10.7 /d	Rig A, B
SN9 iota	RTX 4090-class	$8,883 /d	2 / 256	$69.4 /d	Rig A, B (stretch)
SN34 BitMind	A100-class	$3,374 /d	3 / 256	$39.5 /d	Rig A, B (stretch)
SN4 Targon (TEE)	H100/H200/B200/RTX PRO 6000 TEE profiles	$13,430 /d	3 / 256	$157.4 /d	Rig C only
SN90 KubeTEE (TEE)	H200-class TEE	$6,393 /d	2 / 124	$103.1 /d	Rig C only

Table 4.1 - Mining candidates from the live Miner Playbook (block 9,358,822, TAO $249.30). Values are paper values per earning miner.

** Implied pool EV = per-earner value x rewarded/registered, i.e. what an average rewarded miner's slot is worth. A new entrant competes against optimized incumbents, so realized income is a fraction of implied EV; the plan haircuts it to $30 (conservative), $150 (base) and $500 (optimistic) per consumer card per month, and $200/$400/$800 for the TEE track.*

Platform	Host share	Measured / ask rate	Utilization signal	Payout
Lium (SN51)	95% of fees, USDT	5090 ask $0.90/hr; PRO 6000 SE ask $2.09/hr (Oct 25 live)	Volatile: 85% fleet utilization Oct 24 -> 7% Oct 25; 5090 was 99% rented at peak	USDT, daily-ish, 2-day settlement
Vast.ai	~90-96% (after tier fee)	5090 median $0.86/hr (from $0.39); PRO 6000 median $1.64/hr	Deepest marketplace volume; interruptible pricing	USD balance, weekly
SaladCloud	~70% effective (baked into rates)	5090 measured $0.281/hr average incl. idle hours; top chefs $0.413/hr	97% job-time on 5090 class - the most stable floor	Balance/gift cards or fiat

Table 4.2 - Hosting platform comparison. The strategy uses all three simultaneously; rates as measured/published Oct 2026.

5. The Dynamic Auto-Switch Strategy

The rig's scarcest resource is GPU-hours, and the whole point of ownership is that the software, not a landlord, decides how each hour is spent. The switch rule is simple and testable: keep the card listed on all three platforms, and interrupt rental with subnet mining only when the projected mining yield exceeds 1.25 times the current blended rental rate. The 1.25 risk premium compensates for mining's variance - a rented hour is certain USDT, a mined hour is a lottery-weighted TAO expectation.

In practice the rig spends most of its life in the Salad floor mode, because Salad's 97% job-time already absorbs idle capacity at a rate that beats expected mining yield for a new entrant. The switch fires in two situations: emission events (a subnet's alpha price or reward weight spikes, as happens around model releases) and rental droughts (like the Lium 7% week, when the opportunity cost of mining drops to zero).

The decision ladder below encodes this as four states, and chapter 11 specifies how Infranex BT computes it hourly from data it already collects.

State	Trigger	Action	Expected share of hours
Floor	Salad job running (97% of the time)	Serve rental workload; bank USDT	70-90%
Spike	Mining $/hr > 1.25 x blended rental $/hr	Pull card from Vast/Lium, mine the ranked subnet	5-20%
Drought	All-platform utilization < 30%	Mine continuously; keep Salad enabled for spill-over	5-15%
Maintenance	Thermal or driver alarms	Undervolt check, driver roll, dust service	1-3%

Table 5.1 - Per-hour decision ladder. The 1.25x premium and the drought threshold are the only two knobs.

6. Unit Economics & Payback

The model below is deliberately conservative on the two lines newcomers usually overestimate. Hosting revenue uses live asks multiplied by utilization scenarios of 20-75% (never 100%), and mining revenue uses the haircut expectations from chapter 4 rather than headline per-earner values. Electricity is $0.12/kWh at the wall draws measured in chapter 3, plus $40/month of internet and monitoring overhead. All figures are per month, in USD.

The base case has Rig A netting about $737/month and paying back its $12,990 capex in roughly 18 months; Rig B scales that to $1,720/month at 16 months; Rig C needs its premium hardware to earn TEE-track mining income to justify 24 months. The optimistic case - which requires both a tight rental market and a working mining edge - collapses payback to 7-13 months. The conservative case is the one that matters for the phase gates: Rig A still clears $315/month in the worst realistic scenario, which is why it is the recommended first buy. At no point in the modeled space does any rig go meaningfully cash-negative while operational; the true downside is asset risk, covered in chapter 9.

Scenario	Host $/card	Mine $/card	Rig A net	Rig A payback	Rig B net	Rig B payback	Rig C net	Rig C payback
Conservative	$211	$30	$314	41.5 mo	$676	41.3 mo	$778	50.3 mo
Base	$301	$150	$735	17.7 mo	$1518	18.4 mo	$1598	24.5 mo
Optimistic	$452	$500	$1737	7.5 mo	$3521	7.9 mo	$2958	13.2 mo

Table 6.1 - Monthly economics per rig at $0.12/kWh. Hosting $/card = ask x 0.93 blended share x utilization x 720 h.

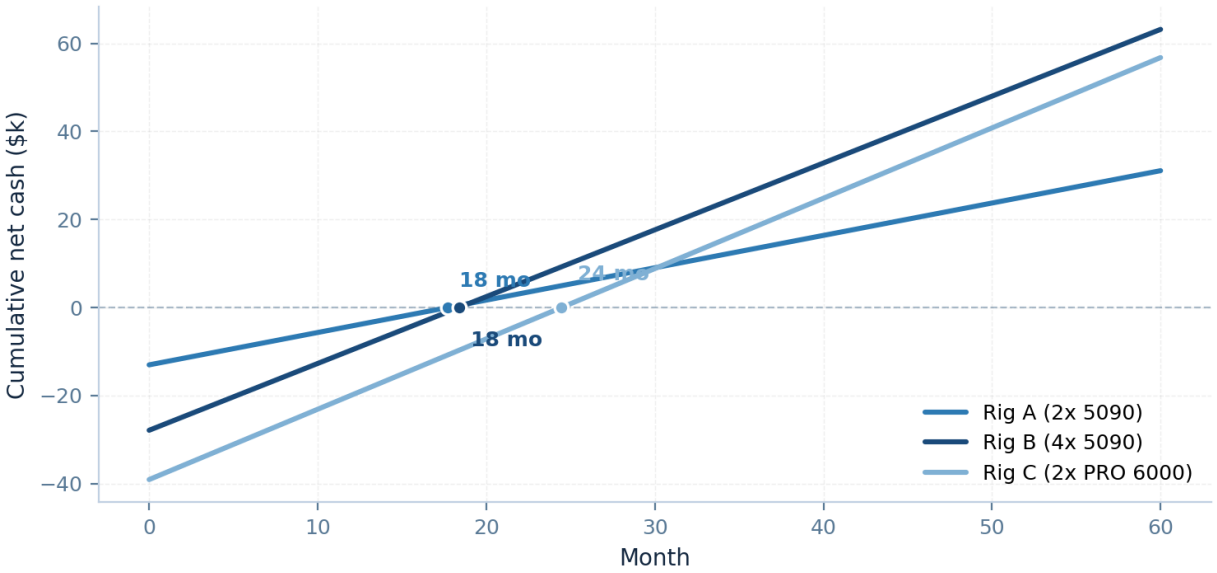


Figure 6.1 - Cumulative net cash position, base case. Rig A crosses zero near month 18.

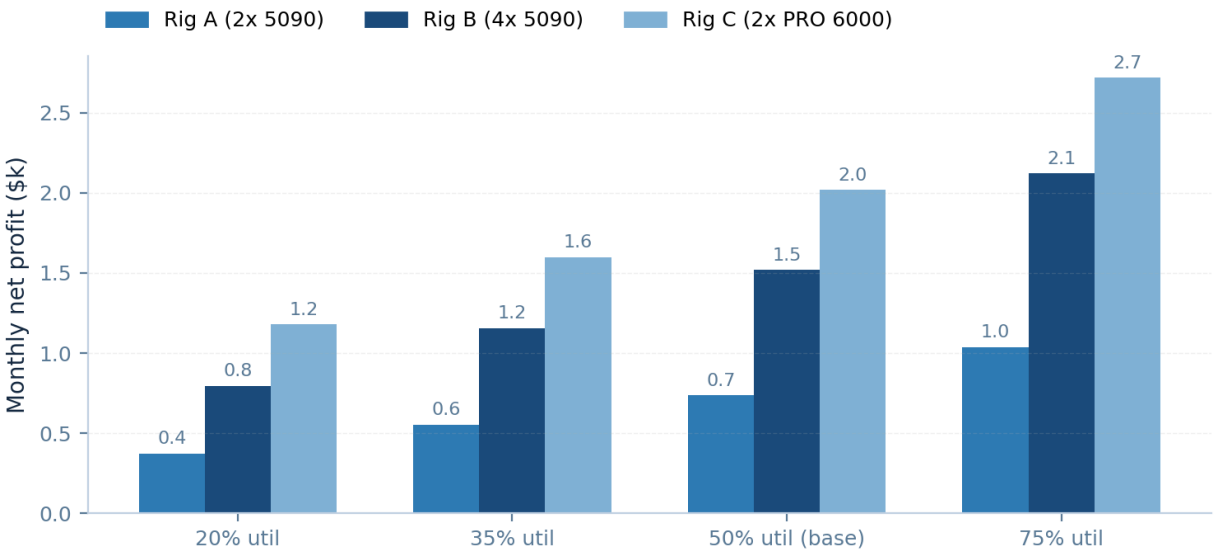


Figure 6.2 - Monthly net profit vs rental utilization at base-case mining. Value labels in $k.

7. Phased Rollout Plan

Capital discipline is enforced by gates, not by optimism. Phase 1 buys exactly one rig and instrument it fully: every rental hour, every mining session, and every dollar of power goes into Infranex BT's tracking from day one. The expansion decision in month 3-5 is mechanical - a 30-day trailing net of at least $400 and utilization of at least 60% - so the plan cannot talk itself into Phase 2 during a lucky week. Phase 3 is intentionally not gated to the others: the TEE track depends on used-market PRO 6000 pricing and Targon-class subnet economics, both of which are moving targets.

The kill criteria matter as much as the gates. If Rig A cannot clear $200/month trailing net after 60 days of competent operation (correct undervolting, all three platforms live, mining configured), the market is telling us the floor is weaker than modeled - and with 5090 resale value supported by the shortage, exiting a Phase 1 rig costs a few hundred dollars in depreciation rather than five figures. This asymmetry - small defined downside, scalable upside - is the core argument for starting now rather than waiting for memory-market relief in 2027.

Phase	When	Action	Gate to next phase
Phase 1 - Prove	Month 0-1	Buy Rig A (2x 5090). Register on Lium (provider path A: Sysbox, add node, Discord), Vast host console, Salad. Mine SN74 + SN94. Track everything in Infranex BT.	30-day trailing net >= $400/mo AND rental utilization >= 60%
Phase 2 - Scale	Month 3-5	Add 2x 5090 (Rig A -> Rig B config) funded by Phase 1 cash flow + optional $3k. Move to Threadripper platform if 9950X saturates.	Trailing net >= $1,200/mo across 4 cards
Phase 3 - TEE option	Month 6+	Only if Targon/KubeTEE economics hold and a used PRO 6000 appears <= $12k: add Rig C. Otherwise hold at Rig B and refinance.	Independent decision, not gated

Table 7.1 - Rollout phases with mechanical gates.

8. Break-Even & Sensitivity Analysis

Each variable is stressed one at a time against the Rig A base case of $737/month net. Two results deserve emphasis. Electricity is a non-issue: the hosting floor alone stays cash-positive up to $0.53/kWh, triple the worst US retail rate in the user's range. The TAO sensitivity is real but bounded: because the mining leg is haircut to $300 of the base case, a 50% TAO drawdown costs $150 per month, not half the business. The dominant variable is hosting utilization, which is why the platform strategy (chapter 5) exists.

The purchase-price row interacts with the asset-bubble risk: buying after a further 30% spike stretches payback to 23 months, while a 30% dip shortens it to 12. The practical instruction is to tranche the buy - one card at market, the second on any dip - and to avoid adding cards into new highs. The worst case is not modeled as a P&L; line but as the kill-switch: if everything idles for a month, the burn is only $167 of electricity and fixed costs, and the cards can be sold into the same shortage that inflated the entry price.

Variable	Change	Rig A base net/mo	Payback	Note
Electricity	$0.08 / kWh	+$42.5 vs base	17.0 mo	Cheap power shortens payback
Electricity	$0.15 / kWh	-$31.8 vs base	18.2 mo	Still comfortably profitable
Hosting utilization	0.50 -> 0.35	-$290.5	41.2 mo	Salad floor dominates downside
Hosting utilization	0.50 -> 0.75	+$301.4	11.2 mo	Peak-demand window
TAO price	-50%	-$150.0	19.5 mo	Mining leg quoted in USD; TAO drop halves it
GPU street price at buy	-30% ($3,640/card)	capex $9,093	12.3 mo	Wait for GDDR7 relief
GPU street price at buy	+30% ($6,760/card)	capex $16,887	22.9 mo	Do not buy into a spike
Everything idle (worst case)	0% rental, 0% mining	-$167.3 /mo burn	never	Kill-switch: sell cards into shortage

Table 8.1 - One-at-a-time sensitivity on Rig A base case ($737/mo net, 17.6-month payback).

9. Risk Register

The register below separates what the data already demonstrated from what could plausibly happen next. The platform-collapse row is not hypothetical - it happened inside this plan's own 48-hour data window, which is precisely why the architecture is three-platform plus mining rather than single-platform plus hope. The two highest-impact rows, emission concentration and the GPU asset bubble, pull in opposite directions: one caps upside, the other threatens capital. Both are mitigated by the same mechanism - the phase gates cap exposed capital at Rig A's $13k until the model is proven by the machine's own accounting, not by forecasts.

Operational risks are managed with boring engineering. Consumer cards on 24/7 duty get undervolted (roughly 50 W per card with 2-4% performance cost), fans are set to conservative curves, and a spare PSU is kept on the shelf because it is the single most common failure point in multi-GPU consumer builds. A 1.5%-of-capex monthly reserve accrues against the day something expensive fails just out of warranty. None of this is exotic; it is the difference between a data centre and a garage space heater.

Risk	Likelihood	Impact	Evidence / mitigation
Platform demand collapse	High	Medium	Lium fleet fell 85% -> 7% rented in 48 h (Oct 24-25, 2026). Mitigate: list on all 3 platforms; Salad floor 97% job-time; auto-switch to mining.
Emission concentration	High	High	Top subnets reward 1-3 of 256 miners; on SN51 the top 10% of UIDs took 99.1% of emissions. Mitigate: treat mining as upside, never as the payback driver.
GPU asset bubble	Medium	High	5090 street price doubled $2,000 -> $5,000+ in 8 months on GDDR7 shortage. A supply response could erase 40-60% of resale value. Mitigate: phase buying, prefer used/refurb, monitor TrendForce memory outlook.
TAO volatility	High	Medium	TAO $248-273 range in Oct 2026, 64% below ATH. Mitigate: auto-convert mining rewards, denominate targets in USD.
Hardware failure	Medium	Medium	24/7 duty at 575 W/card ages consumer boards. Mitigate: undervolt +50 W/card, warranty stacking, spare PSU, reserve 1.5% capex/mo.
Power price spikes	Low	Low	Break-even electricity for the hosting floor alone is $0.53/kWh - far above any US retail rate.
Residential ToS / HOA	Low	High	Some leases and HOAs restrict continuous high-draw equipment. Verify before Phase 1.
Registration scarcity	Medium	Low	Null Consensus (mid-Oct 2026) expanded subnet slots 256 -> 2,500, easing the burn-cost bottleneck.

Table 9.1 - Risk register with likelihood, impact and mitigation.

10. Procurement List

Rig A's list is buildable this month from general-availability stock. The 5090 line uses a $5,200 mid-range street estimate inside the tracked $4,600-6,400 October band; buying a used card with remaining transferable warranty is a legitimate way to land nearer $4,600. Two AIB brands are deliberately mixed so that a single card's thermal design flaw does not idle the rig. The platform lines favor headroom: a 1600 W Platinum unit runs two 575 W cards at 72% utilization of its rating, which is where efficiency and fan noise both live happily.

Rig B and Rig C are deltas, not separate lists, because Phase 2 reuses everything from Rig A except the case (and often the case survives too). The Threadripper jump in both deltas exists for the same reason: four x16 slots and 256 GB of ECC cannot be built on AM5. Rig C's delta is dominated by the PRO 6000 pair - at $16,000 each new, the plan's explicit instruction is to watch the refurb market (currently $14,980+) and Salad Dedicated's contract economics before committing.

Item	Spec	Street $ (Oct 2026)
RTX 5090	32 GB GDDR7, 575 W, partner OC card	5,200 (range 4,600-6,400)
RTX 5090	second card (mix AIB brands)	5,200
CPU	AMD Ryzen 9 9950X	550
Motherboard	X870E with x8/x8 bifurcation	450
RAM	96 GB (2x48) DDR5-6000	320
Storage	4 TB NVMe Gen4 + 1 TB boot	200
PSU	1600 W 80+ Platinum ATX 3.1	380
Cooling	360 mm AIO + 6 case fans + full tower	420
UPS	1500 VA line-interactive pure sine	260
Networking	2.5 GbE, cables, PDU metering	60
TOTAL (Rig A)		13,040 (plan model: 12,990)

Table 10.1 - Rig A procurement list at Oct 2026 street prices.

Item	Rig B delta (vs A)	Rig C delta (vs A)
GPUs	+2x RTX 5090 = +$10,400	2x RTX PRO 6000 WS = $32,000
CPU / board	Threadripper 7970X + WRX90 = +$2,800	Threadripper 7970X + WRX90 = +$2,800
RAM	256 GB ECC = +$680	256 GB ECC = +$680
PSU	second 1600 W = +$320	2x 1600 W = +$320
UPS / net	+$380	+$380
Platform total	+$7,100	+$7,100
Rig total	$27,900	$39,100

Table 10.2 - Phase 2/3 deltas. Rig B reuses Rig A's case, storage and UPS.

11. Infranex BT Integration Spec

Infranex BT already ships the hard parts of this plan: the Opportunities engine computes owned-basis earn picks with TEE gates through computeRentEarn(mode='owned'), the Host & Earn view tracks Lium's fleet and rental economics, /api/network streams TAO price and per-subnet emissions, and the Miner Playbook ranks all 106 researched subnets with rewarded/registered concentration stats. What the plan adds is a Data Centre module that turns those feeds into fleet decisions, specified in the table below.

Two new surfaces carry the weight. The Data Centre module is a capex-and-payback dashboard that mirrors chapter 6's formulas with editable inputs (electricity, ask rates, utilization), shows the phase gates from chapter 7 as tracked sliders, and stores each rig's actual income so payback is computed from the machine's own ledger rather than the model's assumptions. The switch advisor is a hourly banner on the dashboard that

blends the four feeds and answers one question - host, mine, or idle - with a confidence score. Both are modest builds (roughly 3-5 engineering days each) because every data source already exists in the app.

App surface	Feed	Decision it powers
Opportunities (owned basis)	rent-earn.ts computeRentEarn(mode=owned) - already shipped	Which subnets an owned rig can actually mine, TEE gates applied
Host & Earn view	Lium nodes poller + Vast/Akash offers (/api/gpu-offers)	Where to list each card now; utilization crash alarms (the 7% event)
Network snapshot	/api/network - TAO price, per-subnet emissions, miner counts	Mining vs hosting $/hr comparison, per-hour switch recommendation
Miner Playbook	SubnetPlaybook (106 researched entries) + rewarded/registered stats	Subnet shortlist per GPU class with concentration haircuts
New: Data Centre module	Capex inputs + chapter 6 formulas	Live payback tracker, phase-gate dashboard, procurement list
New: switch advisor	Blends the four feeds hourly	Recommendation banner: host / mine / idle per rig, with confidence

Table 11.1 - Integration map: existing and new surfaces, their feeds, and the decisions they drive.

12. Methodology & Data Sources

Every market number in this plan was captured during the last week of October 2026 and is reproducible from the sources listed below. Live chain and fleet figures come from the Infranex BT platform's own snapshot (block 9,358,822) and the Lium public nodes API; rental rates are vendor-published medians or measured fleet averages as dated; hardware prices are tracked retail lows and marketplace bands, not MSRPs. The economics are computed from these inputs by explicit formulas - ask times blended host share times utilization times 720 hours for hosting; per-earner value times rewarded-over-registered times a new-entrant haircut for mining - so any reader can substitute their own electricity rate or utilization view and re-derive every table.

Two caveats bound the whole document. Paper values per earning miner are not income promises: they describe what today's rewarded miners earn, and subnets routinely redistribute rewards when operators change, validators re-weight, or emission schedules shift. And this is an operating plan, not investment advice - the phase gates exist precisely because the honest response to concentration and asset-price risk is to let the machine's tracked cash flow, not a spreadsheet's base case, authorize each next dollar of capital.

#	Source (all accessed Oct 2026)
1	Salad earning rates, RTX 5090 measured Oct 16-22, 2026 (salad.com/earning-rates): $0.281/hr average, $0.413/hr top decile, 97% job-time.
2	Vast.ai public pricing, Oct 2026 (vast.ai/pricing/gpu/RTX-5090): median $0.86/hr on-demand, floor $0.39/hr; RTX PRO 6000 median $1.64/hr (thundercompute.com aggregation, Oct 23, 2026).
3	RTX 5090 street price: Tom's Hardware Sep 2026 ($5,000+ floor), trackalacker.com monthly lows (Aug 2026 $4,100), tech-insider.org tracker (Oct 2026 marketplace $5,000-7,000+); MSRP $1,999.
4	RTX PRO 6000 Blackwell WS: launched Mar 2025 at $8,565; NVIDIA Marketplace $16,000 Oct 2026 (thundercompute.com/pricing).
5	Lium public fleet API (lium.io/api/public/v1/nodes), pulled Oct 25, 2026: 405 GPUs listed across 96 nodes, 27 rented (7%); Oct 24, 2026 snapshot: 1,816 GPUs, 1,543 rented (85%).
6	Infranex BT live chain snapshot, block 9,358,822, TAO $249.30 (Oct 25, 2026); Miner Playbook per-earner and rewarded/registered stats from the same build.
7	Bittensor SN51 Lium economics researched in-project: 95% USDT rental share, miner emission stream ~373 TAO/day, top 10% of UIDs took 99.1% of epoch emissions, 74/256 UIDs earned.
8	Null Consensus upgrade (mid-Oct 2026): subnet participant capacity 256 -> 2,500 (bittensor.ai).

Table 12.1 - Primary data sources.